

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Harappan chronology: regional roots to localisation

EARLY/REGIONALISATION -> MATURE/INTEGRATION -> LATE/LOCALISATION

c. 3300-2600 BCE

c. 2600-1900 BCE

c. 1900-1300 BCE

regional towns/crafts and exchange networks	shared weights, seals, script, urban systems	de-urbanisation, local ceramics, settlement shifts, continuities
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Civilisation = integrated urban-rural network; decline = regional transformation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Harappan spatial system and site atlas

WEST: Sutkagendor -> Makran edge | NORTH: Manda -> Jammu frontier

CORE INDUS: Harappa -> urban/cemetery sequence | Mohenjo-daro -> Great Bath/drains

GHAGGAR: Kalibangan -> ploughed field/fire installations | Banawali -> fortified town

EAST: Rakhigarhi -> major Haryana complex | Alamgirpur -> eastern Late Harappan edge

KUTCH: Dholavira -> three-part city, reservoirs, signboard | Surkotada -> fortification

GUJARAT: Lothal -> basin/warehouse/craft debate | Rangpur -> regional sequence

SINDH: Chanhudaro -> craft centre; no classic citadel-lower-town profile

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Urban-rural settlement hierarchy

FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS -> VILLAGES -> CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES -> REGIONAL CITIES

food and herds storage specialised output coordination/consumption

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weights + seals + transport + shared styles connect unequal regional domains.

Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Built order, water and civic maintenance

PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD HOUSES

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wells/reservoirs -> bathing areas -> covered drains -> soak pits/inspection access

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household investment

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collective maintenance

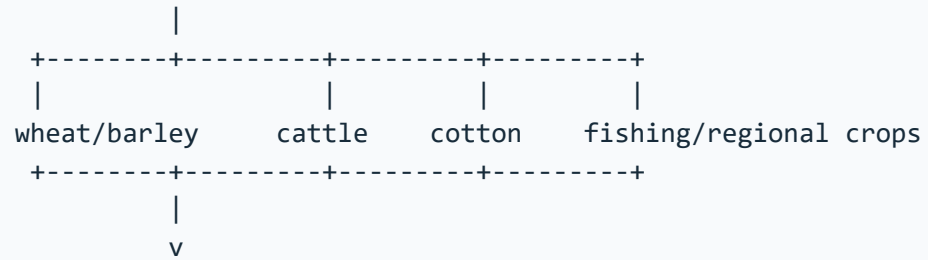
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Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The Harappan economy as a linked system

AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE



SURPLUS -> craft workshops -> calibrated weights -> seals/transport -> exchange
CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Internal and overseas exchange corridors

RAW MATERIAL FLOW

Baluchistan/Afghanistan -> metals/stones -> Indus cities

Rajasthan/Khetri -> copper corridor -> production zones

Gujarat/Kutch -> shell, carnelian, coastal routes -> crafts and ports

Indus/Makran/Gulf -> Dilmun/Magan -> Mesopotamia; Meluhha in cuneiform texts

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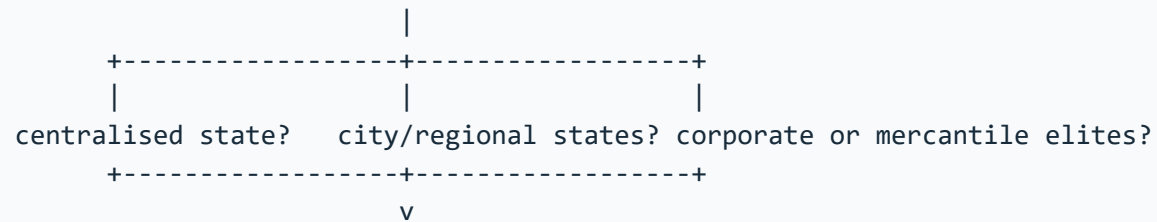
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Trade evidence = imports + texts + seals + production; it does not prove colonies.

Lothal basin has dockyard/reservoir interpretations: state the debate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Society and polity: evidence without invented kings

EVIDENCE: house variation + scarce goods + craft control + standards + public works



NO secure palace, royal tomb or deciphered king-list; hierarchy existed, form is open.

VERDICT: coordinated institutions are certain; empire-level sovereignty is unproven.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Script, seals and religion: evidence ladder

SECURE: short signs, seals/tablets, motifs, ritual installations, burials, figurines

PROBABLE: identity/transaction marking and differentiated ritual practices

DISPUTED: script language; proto-Shiva; mother-goddess system; universal fire altars

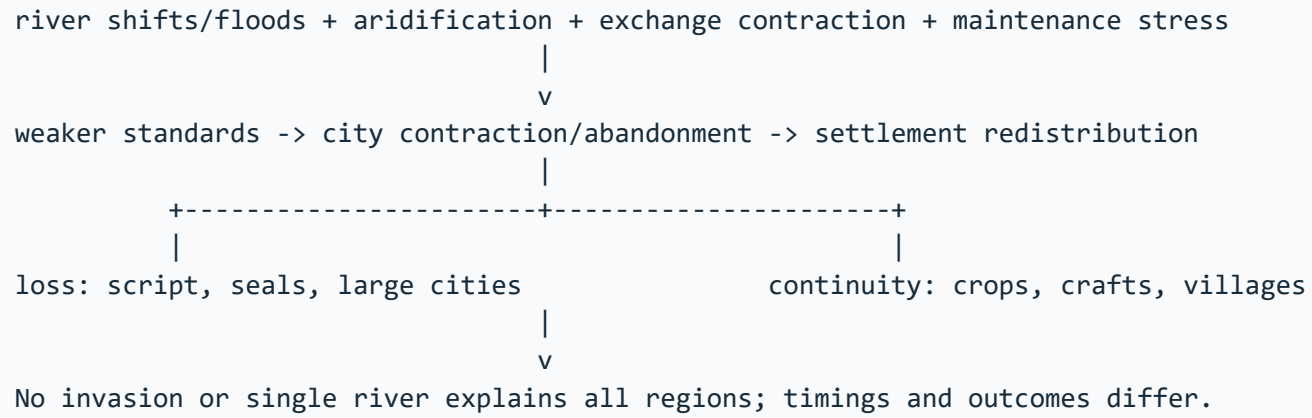
REJECT: reading later Hindu doctrine directly into every Harappan image.

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Undeciphered script blocks direct access to office, belief and political vocabulary.

Use object + context + distribution before analogy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: De-urbanisation: interacting regional causes



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Harappan answer architecture: 10/15/20 marks

10 MARKS: phase -> site-feature triad -> mechanism -> interpretation caution

15 MARKS: chronology -> spatial system -> urban form -> economy -> polity/religion limits

20 MARKS: integration -> site map -> urban-rural economy -> water/standards/trade

-> society-polity evidence -> script/ritual limits -> transformation

BENCHMARK: material uniformity indicates integration, not automatic political unity.

CLOSE: a varied civilisation coordinated by standards, exchange and maintenance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Separate excavated fact from function label and social interpretation.
2. Anchor every claim in site, phase, context, comparison and regional variation.
3. The undeciphered script limits named claims about language, rulers and doctrine.

VERDICT: Harappan history is strongest on material systems, weakest on named ideas.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Citadel, granary, dockyard, Priest-King and Pashupati are modern labels.
2. Horse evidence is rare and disputed; standardisation does not prove one empire.
3. Deurbanisation was regional and multi-causal, not one invasion or drought.

VERDICT: State the secure evidence first, then grade each interpretation.